Catholic Diocese of Kitale

Secretariat Workplace Management System

USER GUIDE

For Heads of Department (HODs)

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Version 1.0

Welcome, Head of Department

This guide walks you through every section of the Diocesan Secretariat Workplace Management System that you will use as a Head of Department (HOD). It is designed to be read end-to-end on your first day, then kept as a quick reference whenever you need a reminder. Each section explains what the area is for, how to get there from the sidebar, and the exact steps for common tasks.

As an HOD you have all the abilities of a regular staff member *plus* the responsibility of overseeing the people, work plans, daily logs and vehicle movements within your department, and maintaining the official staff roster.

How to use this guide

- Read sections in order on your first login - they follow the natural flow of a working week.
- Use the page footer to find your place; sections are independent so you can jump in any order later.
- Anywhere you see a **Save** or **Submit** button, your data is stored in the system - nothing is lost when you close your browser.
- If you ever get stuck, sign out and sign back in - this refreshes your session.

Signing in

1. Open the system in your web browser. The sign-in page appears first.
2. Enter the e-mail address that was registered for you and your password, or use the **Sign in with Google** button if your account is linked.
3. On a successful login you land on your **Dashboard**. The left sidebar (or the top scroller on mobile) is your main map of the system.

Note: Your role - Head of Department - unlocks the HOD-only features described in this guide. If a section listed here is missing from your sidebar, contact the Super Admin to confirm your role.

The Sidebar - Your Map of the System

Everything you need is reached from the maroon sidebar on the left (or the horizontal scrolling bar at the top on a phone). Below is a summary of every entry you will see as an HOD.

Section	What it is for
Dashboard	Your home screen - quick stats and shortcuts.
Work Plans	Create, edit and submit your own weekly work plan.
Vehicle Requests	Request a diocesan vehicle for official travel.
Drivers Log	Log trips you have taken with a diocesan vehicle.
Daily Log	Record what you achieved and any challenges each day.
Monthly Reports	Generate a polished monthly PDF report for any staff member.
My Department	Manage your department: staff roster, plans, logs, trips.
Leave Requests	Apply for leave and review your team's leave applications.
Diocese at a Glance	Read-only directory of the diocese, clergy and leadership.
Archive	Your private, password-protected vault for documents, events and notes.

Two small icons appear in the top-right of every page: the **bell** (notifications) and the **Sign in to office / Sign out of office** attendance button. Use the attendance button when you arrive at the office and again when you leave - it builds your office-attendance record.

1. Dashboard

The Dashboard is your daily home. It shows shortcut cards for the most common tasks (filing a work plan, recording today's log, requesting a vehicle) and key counts for your account. Use it as a starting point each morning.

What to do here

- Glance at the cards to see anything that needs your attention.
- Click any shortcut to jump straight to that area.
- Confirm your name and role in the bottom-left of the sidebar are correct.

2. Work Plans

A work plan lists the activities you intend to carry out in a given week. Submitting it gives the administration visibility of your priorities.

Create a weekly plan

1. Open **Work Plans** from the sidebar.
2. Click **New work plan** and pick the week (the Monday of that week).
3. Add one row per activity: description, expected output, day, and any remarks.
4. Save as draft as you go - your work is preserved.
5. When the plan is complete, click **Submit**. The status changes from *draft* to *submitted* and your administrator can now see it.

Tip: You can edit a draft any time. Once submitted, ask the administrator to reopen it if changes are needed.

3. Vehicle Requests

Use this section whenever your work requires a diocesan vehicle. The request goes to the administration for approval and a driver/vehicle is assigned.

File a request

1. Open **Vehicle Requests** and click **New request**.
2. Fill in: travel date and time, start point, destination, purpose, number of passengers, and any special notes.
3. Submit. You will see the request appear in your list with status *pending*.
4. Refresh later or wait for a notification (bell icon, top-right) when it is approved or declined.
5. After the trip, you can download the approved request as a PDF for your records.

4. Drivers Log

Every trip you take in a diocesan vehicle should be logged here, even short ones. This is what feeds the department's fleet usage and distance reports.

1 Open **Drivers Log** and click **New trip**.

2 Choose the vehicle, enter date, start point, destination, starting kilometres and (after the trip) closing kilometres, plus the passenger count.

3 Save. The system calculates the distance covered automatically.

4 An administrator may later mark the trip as *approved*; once approved it is locked.

5. Daily Log

A short, honest daily journal of what you achieved and any blockers. The Monthly Report is built directly from these entries, so consistency matters.

1 Open **Daily Log**. Today's date is pre-selected.

2 In **Achievements**, list what you completed today - keep it specific.

3 In **Challenges**, note anything that slowed you down or needs help.

4 Click **Save**. You can edit the entry later the same day.

Discipline: Aim to log every working day. Empty days make the Monthly Report look thin.

6. Monthly Reports

This is where you generate a printable report of work done in a given month. As an HOD you can generate one for yourself or for any staff member in your department.

1 Open **Monthly Reports**.

2 Pick the staff member (defaults to you) and the month you want to report on.

3 Review the on-screen summary - it pulls in daily logs, work plans and trips for that month.

4 Click **Download PDF**. A branded, multi-page report is generated for printing or e-mailing.

7. My Department - the heart of your HOD role

This page is your control room. It shows everyone in your department, their work plans, their daily logs and their vehicle trips, and it is where you maintain the official **Staff Roster**.

Staff

The **Staff** card lists every person currently assigned to your department in the system. If someone is missing or shouldn't be there, contact the Super Admin to fix their assignment.

Department Staff Roster (HOD-managed)

The roster is the formal name/title/phone/email list of your department. Only you (and the Super Admin) can edit it. It is the source of truth for the Secretariat Staff document the Super Admin downloads.

1 Click **Add staff** to open the form.

2 Enter Full name (required), Title / Position, Phone, and Email.

3 Click **Add**. The entry appears in the roster table immediately.

4 Use the pencil icon to edit an entry, or the bin icon to remove one.

5 Click **Download PDF** at the top of the card to save a branded copy of the full roster.

Why this matters: The Super Admin's *Secretariat Staff* page groups your roster under your department, with you listed first as HOD. Keeping the roster current is part of your job.

Recent work plans, daily logs and vehicle trips

Below the roster you'll see the latest activity from your team:

- **Recent work plans** - the latest plans submitted by your staff, with their status.
- **Recent daily logs** - what each staff member recorded as achievements and challenges.
- **Vehicle trips** - a summary of trips with a per-staff breakdown of trips taken and kilometres covered.

Use this information for your weekly check-ins and to spot staff who may have stopped logging.

8. Leave Requests

Use this section to apply for your own leave and to review leave applications submitted by your staff.

Applying for leave

1. Open **Leave Requests** and click **New request**.
2. Choose the leave type, start date and end date, and provide a short reason.
3. Submit. The administrator/Super Admin will be notified for approval.

Reviewing staff leave

Requests from staff in your department appear in your list. Open each one to see the dates and reason. Final approval is handled at the administration level, but your awareness as HOD is expected.

9. Diocese at a Glance

A reference directory of the diocese - leadership, departments, clergy and key events. You can browse it freely; editing is reserved to higher-level administrators.

10. Archive - Your Private Vault

The Archive is a strictly private area that only you can open. Not even the Super Admin can see what you keep here. It is protected by a password that **you** create.

First-time setup

1. Click **Archive** in the sidebar.
2. Choose a password (at least 6 characters) and confirm it. Click **Create password**.
3. You are now inside your Archive.

Every other visit

1. Click **Archive**, type your password, and click **Unlock**.
2. Use the **Lock** button (top-right) before stepping away from your computer.

Inside the Archive

- **Documents** - upload any file (PDF, Word, photo, scan...) with an optional description. Download or delete any time.
- **Calendar** - add events you want to track personally: meetings, deadlines, anniversaries. Date, time, location and notes.
- **Notes** - a free-text scratchpad. Save important information you don't want anyone else to see.

Changing your Archive password

1. When unlocked, click **Change password** at the top.
2. Enter your current password, then the new one twice. Click **Update**.

If you forget your Archive password

1. On the unlock screen, click **Forgot password? Reset it**.

2 Enter your **account login password** (the one you use to sign in to the system) to confirm it is really you.

3 Set and confirm a new Archive password, then click **Reset password**.

Security reminder: Choose a password you can remember, do not write it on your desk, and never share it. Your archive is yours alone.

11. Office Attendance and Notifications

Office attendance button

At the top of every page is a button that toggles between **Sign in to office** and **Sign out of office**. Tap it when you arrive in the morning and again when you leave. Your daily attendance is recorded and feeds the Office Attendance reports the administration sees.

Notification bell

The bell beside the attendance button lights up when there is something to read - for example a vehicle request that has been approved, or a new diocesan-wide announcement. Click the bell to open the list and mark items as read.

Suggested Daily Routine for an HOD

1. Sign in. Click **Sign in to office**. Check the notification bell.
2. Open **My Department** and skim the latest daily logs from your staff.
3. Throughout the day, file any vehicle requests and update your work plan if priorities shift.
4. Before lunch, jot a quick mid-day note in your Archive if useful.
5. End of day: open **Daily Log**, record achievements and challenges, save.
6. Click **Sign out of office** before closing your browser.

Suggested Weekly Routine

1. **Monday morning:** create and submit your work plan for the week.
2. **Mid-week:** review your team's submitted work plans under **My Department**.
3. **Friday afternoon:** ensure all daily logs are filled in. Update the staff roster if anyone has joined, left, or changed phone/email.
4. **End of month:** open **Monthly Reports** and download a PDF report for yourself and each staff member as required.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to try first
A page won't load or shows an error	Sign out, close the tab, sign back in. If it persists, contact the Super Admin.
Your role is wrong (missing HOD features)	Ask the Super Admin to confirm your user role and department assignment.
You can't see a staff member in My Department	They may not be assigned to your department in their profile. Contact the Super Admin.
A vehicle request is stuck on 'pending'	Approval is done by the administration. Follow up with them directly.

You forgot your Archive password	Use **Forgot password? Reset it** on the unlock screen and confirm with your account login password.
You forgot your system login password	Use the password reset option on the sign-in page, or contact the Super Admin.

A Final Word

Thank you for the leadership you bring to your department. The system is here to make your administrative work simpler, your team more visible, and your reports easier to produce. Use it daily, keep the roster current, log honestly - and the rest takes care of itself.

- Diocesan Secretariat, Catholic Diocese of Kitale